

Agentic Coding

CHEAT SHEET

Projects, skills & safe work

01 Projects & Plan Mode

Project • Dedicated workspace with files, context, and rules for one area of work.

Metaphor: 🍽️ Restaurant

Files and folders • Focused task material shared with Codex as context.

Metaphor: 🛒 Ingredient basket

Clarifying question • Resolve an important missing decision before work starts.

Metaphor: 🧑 Chef asks the guest

Access mode • Sets what the agent may do and when it needs approval.

Metaphor: 🔑 Kitchen key

Plan Mode • Gather context, ask questions, and propose a plan before implementation.

Metaphor: 📝 Preparation plan

Implement plan • Start work after reviewing the proposed approach.

Metaphor: ▶️ Start cooking

02 Skills & tools

Skill • A reusable playbook for a focused task.

Metaphor: 📖 Recipe card

SKILL.md • Main file with the skill's trigger, workflow, and constraints.

Metaphor: 📖 Recipe

openai.yaml • Metadata for how a local skill appears and starts.

Metaphor: 🏷️ Recipe label

Tool • Program or interface for retrieving information or taking action.

Metaphor: 🛠️ Kitchen tool

Plugin • Installable bundle of apps, skills, and connected capabilities.

Metaphor: 🧰 Toolbox

Skill + plugin • Repeatable process using information or actions from another tool.

Metaphor: 📖 Recipe + toolbox

03 Safe work

Use least access • Choose the narrowest access that still allows the task.

Metaphor: 🔑 One kitchen key

Share minimum context • Add only the files and folders the task needs.

Metaphor: 🥕 Ingredients for one dish

Use trusted sources • Review skills, plugins, instructions, and requested access before use.

Metaphor: ✅ Approved supplier

Keep human approval • A person decides before sending, publishing, deleting, or spending money.

Metaphor: 🧑 Head chef signs off

Verify the result • Check facts, names, prices, dates, links, sources, and brand tone.

Metaphor: 🍷 Taste test

Test on a copy • Preview changes and keep a backup of the original.

Metaphor: 🍽️ Practice plate + spare

Stop and report • Disconnect the tool and tell the responsible person if something looks wrong.

Metaphor: 🛑 Emergency stop